

Introduction

National Lottery Project Grants

Arts Council National Lottery Project Grants is our funding programme for arts, museums and libraries projects. It is always open, so we can respond to people's good ideas.

Application form

In this application form we will ask you questions about:

- your project
- the people and communities who will experience your project
- your planning
- you or your organisation

When we read your answers we will think about how your project will help to make a difference to the creative and cultural lives of the people and communities in England. We will also think about how likely it is to achieve what you want it to.

The information you give us in this application form will help us decide which applications we will fund.

Remember

The first few screens are already completed with information you've provided in your applicant profile. If you need to make changes to these screens, go back to the 'Applicants' section and you can edit your applicant profile.

Throughout the application form, any questions marked with an asterisk (*) must be answered to allow you to submit the form.

The text boxes have a character limit which includes letters, numbers, symbols and spaces. Please stick to this character limit as any additional text won't be saved.

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Applicant details

Applicant name: Ben Hart

Applicant number: 51021975

Applicant type: Individual

What name is your bank account registered in? Mr Benjamin Stefan Hart

Main art form: Music

Are you based within England or the wider United Kingdom? Yes

Applicant: Ben Hart

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NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Address information

Non-UK address or address not found: ☐

Address name or number: Flat 3,60

Street: Millennium Place

Locality:

Town / city: LONDON

Postcode: E2 9FJ

Main contact number: 07504788545

Mobile:

Email address: hartmngt@gmail.com
(Organisation email address
if applicant is an organisation)

Website address:

Fax number:

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Your project

What do we mean by 'project'? For us, a project is something that has:

- A start and end date
- Clear things you want to achieve in that time
- Ways for people to experience or take part in creativity or culture (either as part of the project or in the future)

This section of the application form helps us to understand what you want to do.

It allows you to think about how your project could help to bring creativity and culture to people in England.

When is your project going to happen?

Tell us the start and end dates for your project.

Remember:

- To allow enough time to deliver all the stages of your project
- The dates you give us here should cover the whole project period you're applying for
- We need eight weeks to process applications for £30,000 and under, your start date must be more than eight weeks from the date you submit your application
- To allow enough time for us to make a payment before your start date, if your application is funded

Project start date: 16/09/2024

Project end date: 30/09/2025

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Responding to any Time limited priorities

Your project is responding to the following Time limited priority:

Selected priority: - Not applying against any Time Limited Priority -

At a glance

In your own words, give a short, clear overview of your project:

Up to 500 characters

- Be as clear as you can about what you want to do using Project Grants funding
- It's better if this is written as a full paragraph
- It will be available to the public on our website if your application is funded.

The HART Initiative (THI) pioneers a vital culture shift in the UK music ecology; demonstrating the positive impact of equity models for songwriters who are unfairly paid; creating collab opps for established & emerging artists to start & sustain their careers.

THI generates a Proof of Concept (PoC) framework, inc: a 2wk songwriting camp, video shoots, livestream showcase, listening party & performance, industry networking, & global release of 1 mixtape & 2 singles.

If you had to explain the focus of your project to someone, what single words or short phrase would you use?

Up to 100 characters

- You can be as broad or as specific as you like; it's your project
- You might think about this as your project's 'key words' or 'tags'
- Use a maximum of 5 key words or short phrases
- We won't use this response when deciding which applications to fund. It's so we can learn from how you see your project.
- Examples could be: singing; photography; digital work in libraries; South Asian dance; participatory arts; children's theatre; interactive gaming; dynamic collections work; changing business models; environmental theme; writing with older people; etc

Songwriting camp & mixtape release; disruptive model; emerging & established producers & artists

Our Strategy, Let's Create

Let's Create explains how we want our funding to make a difference. It includes three Outcomes. These Outcomes are what we want to achieve through the projects we fund, so together we can make a difference.

You don't need to read our Strategy to make an application for £30,000 and under.

Telling us what your project focuses on helps us to decide which of the Outcomes your project will make a difference towards.

What does your project mainly focus on?

- this gives us a good sense of how you see your project
- you need to select only one option
- your project may include activity to do with more than one option; we want to know where you feel the main focus is
- the descriptions below are a guide to help you decide
- don't worry if you're not sure – we'll check we agree with the option you've selected when we look at your application

My project is about the public taking part

My project is about the public taking part in creative activity, either during the project or in the future.

☐

- This means a project that gives the public the opportunity to take an active part in creative activity.
- An active part might be making, learning or contributing to creating something.
- The public includes anyone who isn't working professionally in the cultural sector, and covers all ages from early years to older people.
- Examples could be delivering workshops to the public, the public participating in an event or teaching the public..
- People might be trying something for the first time, or developing their skills and experience.
- It could be that you're developing workshop content that you'll deliver to the public in the future.
- This isn't about the public attending an event as an audience member or visitor to an exhibition.

This matches our Outcome 1: Creative People

My project is about making a difference to a place or community

My project is about making a difference to a place or community, either during the project or in the future.

☐

- This means working in a way that is focused on a specific place or community.
- Often working in a place will mean working with other partners in that place to shape and deliver a project.
- Projects could involve making, showing or performing work that responds to what a particular community is interested in.
- Examples could include a locally developed cultural festival, engaging the community in research and development for a new programme, work or event, or touring an exhibition with support from local partners.
- Projects might connect to or help to deliver existing local strategies or support local partnerships.
- It could also mean touring work into places where there is local demand. .

This matches our Outcome 2: Cultural Communities

My project is about developing professional creative or cultural practice

My project is about developing professional creative or cultural practice, either during the project or in the future.

X

- This means activity which makes a difference to an individual's, group's, or organisation's creative or cultural practice, or a difference to the wider cultural sector. Examples could be:
- Developing or showing new work or new ideas, including with partners from inside or outside the cultural sector
- Using new technologies to create or distribute work.
- Developing new skills to help those at the beginning of their careers or to help others sustain careers
- Bringing work, publications or collections from abroad to audiences in England.
- Developing international partnerships to do research or to create and present new work

This matches our Outcome 3: A Creative and Cultural Country

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In more detail

Give us a more detailed description of your project: what you want to do and why you want to do it
Up to 3000 characters

This is a chance for you to tell us about your project in your own words

- What do you hope will be the result of your project?
 - What's the creative and/or cultural idea behind it?
 - Is there a difference you want to make by doing the project?
 - What steps will you take to achieve this?
-
- Be as clear as you can about what you want to do
 - You can write this in full paragraphs or in bullet points

The HART Initiative (THI) pioneers a culture shift within the UK's music ecology; facilitating connectivity between grassroots & commercial industry cultures. THI:

- radically disrupts the music industry's elitist gatekeeping paradigm to de-silo professional opps for emergent artists through targeted change & upskilling
- advocates for an equity model for songwriters; usually unfairly paid within the industry
- pairs 4 emerging producers/writers with 4 established industry professionals; intentionally curated for impactful upskilling & a dynamic creation process
- generates a replicable PoC framework.

Lead by songwriter/artist/producer Ben Hart (HART), THI hosts:

- a 2 week songwriting camp at a world class venue, Strongroom Studios; offering marginalised artists & songwriters access to world class tech & equipment; combating social & financial barriers to accessibility
- the creation & global release of an 8 song alternative RnB/soul/pop mixtape & 2 singles; available on all all digital streaming platforms (DSPs). Mixtapes are a normative method for artist promo within the urban music ecology
- 3 industry-standard music video shoots; in collab with prod company Skitch
- a livestream showcase; direct exposure to industry execs & creatives, visibilising independent artists
- a pinnacle listening event & performance at Sixty Six Sounds
- a PR campaign & coordination with Wired PR; a company that repeatedly catapults independent artists to the mainstream
- the digital distribution of publicly available pedagogical resources; for industry & independent creatives.

THI boldly favours a win-win philosophy: the cross-pollination of creative styles, ideas & practices, to elevate quality & innovation; raising the global standard of music/production to represent minority artists' existence.

THI's creative team consists of HART +:

- 4 emerging Global Majority creatives: Tej, Lewis Ostwald, Ivo Todorov & Sundjata
- 4 otherwise inaccessible established artists/producers: JD Reid (Mabel; Skepta), Jabari Manwa (BROCKHAMPTON), Mahalia (gold selling artist) & Max Pope (Mahalia; ABRA).

Small Green Shoots (SGS) will connect 2 management interns; mentored thru THI.

THI exposes independent artists to industry insights & connections, better equipping them to achieve commercial sustainability; supporting with:

- professional photoshoots
- developing professional EPKs
- online workshop with PRS
- lessons in networking, negotiation & business skills.

10 care packages will be sent to industry elite as part of the mixtape distribution; inc. handmade sculptures & bespoke messages; a standard practice for commercial album releases; uncommon in grassroots music.

THI develops relationships with PRS, SGS & The Hidden Artists Network to

establish signposting opps for future iterations; drawing on THI's evaluation to nourish a hothouse; radically disrupting the industry, & bridging the accessibility gaps between independent & commercial music cultures.

What's led you or your organisation to do this project now?

Up to 1500 characters

- What ideas or experiences have led you or your organisation to this point?
- Is this project helping you or your organisation learn or try new things?
- If you've done something similar before, how is this different?
- You can write this in full paragraphs or in bullet points

HART is an independent artist/producer/writer from London; now at a tipping point in his career.

As an artist, HART has acquired:

- 500k Soundcloud plays, & 250k on Apple Music for single 'VOODOO PLANS'
- 10-50k streams on more recent (less financially backed) singles inc 'KIWI'
- BBC Radio 1/1Xtra support from DJ Target, BeniB and Casskid
- BBC Intro plays
- US-based management (invested £3k)
- interest & publishing deal offers from labels, inc Sony; choosing not to sign to retain creative autonomy.

He has written/prod. for:

- *(Insta followers)
- Mahalia (638k) on EP, & 2nd album; securing 9 cuts inc ft from Stormzy, Destin Conrad & Joyce Wrice
- Jabari Manwa (111k), member of BROCKHAMPTON, for solo mixtape & album
- RM, member of BTS (46M)
- Sinead Harnett (458k)
- Aitch (2.2M)
- The England Lionesses; a commission related to the 2023 World Cup.

Throughout his career, HART has experienced difficulties acquiring industry opps due to gatekeeping & elitist tropes. In addition, as a songwriter, he has received unfair pay cuts on the songs he has co/written; due to inherent systemic payment flaws in the commercial music industry.

THI actively combats the classist attitudes that bear down on HART professionally; equitizing the position of 'songwriter' within the industry, & legitimising HART's position as an artist too; not only sustaining his own career, but also improving career sitelines for other emergent artists to sustain their creative careers too.

How will you know if you've achieved what you set out to do?

Up to 1500 characters

- Are there opportunities for learning and reflection during your project?
- How will you know what difference the project has made?
- What steps will you take to understand what people thought of the project?
- You can write this in full paragraphs or in bullet points

THI forms a creative stakeholder board with project peers, participants & partners; with regular meetings during & 3/6 months post project; evaluating qualitative & quantitative KPIs inc:

- THI connectivity; # of independent-industry connections made within the project
- participants' skills dev; creative technique, technological use, & industry insight
- social impact: participants' confidence, style & artistic expression
- collaboration impact; how much each of the artist cohorts have inspired the mixtape's sound & style
- skills dev & social impact of management interns
- # partners committed to supporting future iterations of THI
- # artists offered industry breaks, inc publishing deals as a result of THI; & general long term social impact
- # downloads of pedagogical docs; distributed via project partners

Relationships with partners will be maintained to ensure continued signposting & visibilising of THI. Current Partners inc:

- PRS Music Foundation: currently in discussion regarding connectivity to their initiatives; Keychange & Power Up
- Small Green Shoots: supporting YP (18-24) with music industry related dev opps
- The Hidden Artists Network: an interactive digital platform designed to develop, & improve outcomes for artists & their projects.

THI captures this first iteration as a POC; maintaining contact with project participants & embedding their voices in the development of future iterations.

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Example

Example

This is your chance to bring your project to life.

You could:

- Give us a sense of what it looks like or sounds like
- Give us a flavour of what previous work has looked like or sounded like
- Show us work from other practitioners involved which relates to your project

You can provide a weblink or an attachment.

- Up to five pages if it's an attachment
- One webpage
- Up to three minutes of an audio or video file hosted online
- Files that are no bigger than 10MB

The formats we accept are:

- PDF
- Microsoft Word
- Microsoft Excel
- Microsoft PowerPoint
- JPEG file
- Webpage

Web link:

Document Type	Required?	Document description	Date attached
Click to add attachment...	No	Getting Paid in t...	26/06/2024

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Attachment Details

Document description: Getting Paid in the Music Industry

People and communities

This section of the application form helps you to explain:

- Who will experience your project
- How you will reach them
- Where your project will take place
- How it is inclusive and relevant to the people you want to reach

What do we mean by 'communities'?

- A group of people with a characteristic in common, for example:
 - Age
 - Race
 - Class
- A group of people living in the same place, a place could be something
 - Small like a street or town, or
 - Large like a local authority or a county
- A group of people with the same interests or connection, for example:
 - Students
 - Gardeners
 - Community choir
- It could be some or all these things, for example:
 - a group of people with a characteristic in common, living in the same place

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Who will experience it

Who will get to experience your project? Specific communities will experience the project

Who is the community or communities you plan to reach?

Up to 300 characters

- this can be a bullet point list

- Established Industry Professionals
- Music Artists
- Songwriters
- Producers
- Independent/Emerging artists & producers
- The Music Industry

Communities

Do you plan to reach any of these specific communities with your project:

People in a particular age group.	☐
People who share a particular ethnicity.	☐
People who have a particular disability.	☐
People with a particular sexual orientation.	☐
People who are of a particular gender.	☐

How will people experience your project?

Tick as many as feel relevant.

*You need to select at least one option and tell us how many people.

As audience members in a physical space ☒

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How many people: 30

As audience members in a digital space ☒

How many people? 350,050

As visitors in a physical space ☐

As visitors in a digital space ☐

As participants in the project, in a physical space ☐

As participants in the project, in a digital space ☒

How many people: 4

As volunteers in a physical space ☐

As volunteers in a digital space ☒

How many people: 2

As creative or cultural practitioners contributing to or taking part ☒

How many people: 16

As users of a digital product ☒

How many people: 100

As readers of a book, or a physical or electronic publication ☐

People will experience it in the longer-term, after the project has ended. ☐

What information have you used to work out how many people will experience your project?

Up to 800 characters

PHYSICAL:

Showcase at Sixty Sixty Sounds (50 Capacity and 60% turnout = 30 people)

DIGITAL:

- Based on HART & Tebs (head of a&r @ Mark Ronson's 'Zelig' Records) insight + advertising conversion est: £4400 = 200,000 streams from major DSPs + 150,000 streams from non-monetised platforms eg. Youtube.
- est 50 participants on Strongroom livestream showcase

ONLINE PARTICIPANTS & participants

- PRS workshop for 4 emerging creatives
- PRS Employee Host & Ben Hart facilitate

PRACS:

- 1 manager
- 1 director/artist
- 2 Small Green Shoots management Interns
- 4 Emerging Songwriters/Producers/Artists
- 4 Established Producers/Artists
- 1 Mixing & Mastering Engineer
- 1 Creative Director/Sculptor
- 1 Photographer
- 1 Videographer

DIGITAL PRODUCT

100 est downloads of pedagogical resource doc

Reaching people

You've told us who will get to experience your project and how they will experience it.

What steps are you taking to make sure your project reaches these people?

Up to 1500 characters

- What steps will you take to make sure people are aware of your project?
- If relevant, what marketing activities are planned?

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For the distribution of the mixtape & singles THI works with
-Wired PR; an award winning company that have run campaigns for industry elite. Their expertise will be integral to the reach & distribution of THI's project/mixtape & singles.

-Digital Marketing Executive Tom Chaplin, founder of Tribal Digital.

To ensure direct exposure to industry execs & creatives, THI will:

-send 10 bespoke care packages to elite industry figures; a common industry practice and way to forge connection with individuals who can significantly advance music careers

-host a listening party at Sixty Six sounds with 30 paid participants connected to the project & personally invited industry figures

-deliver a livestream showcase direct from world class venue Strongroom Studios; legitimising the project's quality & amplifying the collaborative value of THI.

The team will distribute content to social media, inc Established Artists:

*(followers)

JD Reid (7,892)

Jabari Manwa (111K)

Max Pope (6,127)

Mahalia (638K)

THI draws on an inimitable network; holding substantial connection to established grassroots networks, creative hubs & artists, & industry "untouchables" too.

Where

Where is your project happening?

We want to know the places that your project will happen.

This table explains the options for telling us where your project is happening, including if it's not happening anywhere specific.

Please select as many options as are relevant.

Select	Location options	Description
☒	My project includes an activity happening in one physical place	A creative or cultural activity or event where the people viewing, taking part or working on the activity are physically present. This could be a one-off activity or event or something that happens more than once in the same place. For example a performance, a place you're using to create new work, a research and development space, an exhibition, workshops.
☐	My project includes the same or similar work happening in several physical places	A creative or cultural work or event happening in more than one location. This can be either at the same time or one after another. For example Touring a piece of work or an exhibition, or a workshop series. This is where the people viewing or taking part are physically present.
☒	My project includes streaming or broadcasting	A creative or cultural work or event that is being live streamed on a website or broadcast on tv or radio for example. There may be people physically present at the event, but there are also people viewing or taking part who are not physically present.
☐	My project includes a digital experience	A creative or cultural product that is designed to be experienced through a digital platform or hardware. For example cultural learning through gaming, an immersive experience through virtual reality or a phone app.
☐	My project includes things that aren't happening anywhere specific	For example your project might focus on developing your organisation, you might be creating something new which you'll share with the public after the project end date, you might be doing some research to inform future public-facing work

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Location

Here you can build a list of where your project is happening.

The location(s) you add to this list need to match what you've selected on the Where table on the previous screen.

You can select the same option or different options as many times as you want until you have a list of the places that your project will happen.

Using the tool below, please enter the location(s) where activity is happening. To add a location, click the 'Add new item' icon on the left of the screen. To add more than one location, use the 'Save and Add another' button.

If your project is not happening in a specific place, select 'Project includes things that aren't happening anywhere specific' on the Where screen and delete any locations you have added to this list.

Name of activity	Location option	Venue name	Local authority	Start date	End date	Number	Expected /Confirmed
Writing Camp @ Strongroom ...	One physical place	Strongroom	Hackney	30/09/2024	14/10/2024	14	Confirmed to happen
Listening Event @ Sixty Six...	One physical place	Sixty Sixty Sounds	Camden	21/02/2025	21/02/2025	1	Confirmed to happen
Xavier King Photo Shoots Pe...	One physical place	1	Haringey	21/10/2024	22/10/2024	2	Confirmed to happen
Ben Stonely Video Shoot Dates	One physical place	Victoria Park	Tower Hamlets	25/10/2024	04/11/2024	2	Confirmed to happen
Fortnightly Project & Budge...	Streaming or Broadcast		Tower Hamlets	22/09/2024	03/03/2025	12	Confirmed to happen
Stakeholder Meetings	Streaming or Broadcast		Tower Hamlets	30/09/2024	16/04/2025	8	Confirmed to happen
Tribal Digital Strategy Mee...	Streaming or Broadcast		Tower Hamlets	11/12/2024	11/12/2024	1	Confirmed to happen
Wired PR Strategy Meeting I...	Streaming or Broadcast		Tower Hamlets	10/12/2024	10/12/2024	1	Confirmed to happen
Project Evaluation Meeting ...	Streaming or Broadcast		Tower Hamlets	24/03/2025	24/03/2025	1	Confirmed to happen
Wired PR - Campaign Review ...	Streaming or Broadcast		Tower Hamlets	10/04/2025	10/04/2025	1	Confirmed to happen

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PRS workshop for emergent p...	Streaming or Broadcast		Tower Hamlets	27/11/2024	27/11/2024	1	Confirmed to happen
Livestream showcase @ Stron...	One physical place	Strongroom	Hackney	14/10/2024	14/10/2024	1	Confirmed to happ...

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Location details

Name of activity: Writing Camp @ Strongroom Studios To Record The Project

Location options: One physical place

Location details

Click to use postcode search:

or

Click if within UK but no postcode is available:

Click if international venue:

Name of place: Strongroom

Street: Curtain Road

Town/city: LONDON

Postcode: EC2A 3SQ

Local authority: Hackney

Start date: 30/09/2024

End date: 14/10/2024

Number of times the activity is happening:

Number: 14

Contact name for the place:

Name: Jess Camillerri

Contact email address for the place:

Email: Jess@strongroom.com

Is the activity

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Confirmed to happen here

Location details

Name of activity: Listening Event @ Sixty Sixty Sounds

Location options: One physical place

Location details

Click to use postcode search:

or

Click if within UK but no postcode is available:

Click if international venue:

Name of place: Sixty Sixty Sounds

Street: Denmark Street

Town/city: LONDON

Postcode: WC2H 8NJ

Local authority: Camden

Start date: 21/02/2025

End date: 21/02/2025

Number of times the activity is happening:

Number: 1

Contact name for the place:

Name: Jan Smosarski

Contact email address for the place:

Email: jansmosarski@gmail.com

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Is the activity

Confirmed to happen here

Location details

Name of activity: Xavier King Photo Shoots Personal Studio

Location options: One physical place

Location details

Click to use postcode search:

or

Click if within UK but no postcode is available:

Click if international venue:

Name of place: 1

Street: Lauradale Road

Town/city: LONDON

Postcode: N2 9LT

Local authority: Haringey

Start date: 21/10/2024

End date: 22/10/2024

Number of times the activity is happening:

Number: 2

Contact name for the place:

Name: Xavier King

Contact email address for the place:

Email: xavieraking@gmail.com

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Is the activity

Confirmed to happen here

Location details

Name of activity: Ben Stonely Video Shoot Dates

Location options: One physical place

Location details

Click to use postcode search:

or

Click if within UK but no postcode is available:

Click if international venue:

Name of place: Victoria Park

Street: Grove Road

Town/city: LONDON

Postcode: E3 5TB

Local authority: Tower Hamlets

Start date: 25/10/2024

End date: 04/11/2024

Number of times the activity is happening:

Number: 2

Contact name for the place:

Name: Ben Stonely

Contact email address for the place:

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Email: bstonely@gmail.com

Is the activity

Confirmed to happen here

Location details

Name of activity: Fortnightly Project & Budget Mgmt Meetings w. Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns, & Stakeholder Meetings - ZOOM

Location options: Streaming or Broadcast

Will the event be streamed or broadcast locally, nationally or internationally?:

Please select all that apply: Local - the local authority where you're based (this can include up to three other local authorities)

Please click the 'Save' button below after you have answered the question.

Local authority: Tower Hamlets

Home local authority (above)

Please select up to 3 additional local authorities if required:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Start date: 22/09/2024

End date: 03/03/2025

Number of times streamed/ broadcast:

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Number: 12

Name of broadcaster or streaming service/host:

Name: Zoom

Is the stream or broadcast

Confirmed to happen

Location details

Name of activity: Stakeholder Meetings

Location options: Streaming or Broadcast

Will the event be streamed or broadcast locally, nationally or internationally?:

Please select all that apply: Local - the local authority where you're based (this can include up to three other local authorities)

Please click the 'Save' button below after you have answered the question.

Local authority: Tower Hamlets

Home local authority (above)

Please select up to 3 additional local authorities if required:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Start date: 30/09/2024

End date: 16/04/2025

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Number of times streamed/ broadcast:

Number: 8

Name of broadcaster or streaming service/host:

Name: Zoom

Is the stream or broadcast

Confirmed to happen

Location details

Name of activity: Tribal Digital Strategy Meeting Including SGS Interns - ZOOM

Location options: Streaming or Broadcast

Will the event be streamed or broadcast locally, nationally or internationally?:

Please select all that apply: Local - the local authority where you're based (this can include up to three other local authorities)

Please click the 'Save' button below after you have answered the question.

Local authority: Tower Hamlets

Home local authority (above)

Please select up to 3 additional local authorities if required:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Start date: 11/12/2024

End date: 11/12/2024

Number of times streamed/ broadcast:

Number: 1

Name of broadcaster or streaming service/host:

Name: Zoom

Is the stream or broadcast

Confirmed to happen

Location details

Name of activity: Wired PR Strategy Meeting Including Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - ZOOM

Location options: Streaming or Broadcast

Will the event be streamed or broadcast locally, nationally or internationally?:

Please select all that apply: Local - the local authority where you're based (this can include up to three other local authorities)

Please click the 'Save' button below after you have answered the question.

Local authority: Tower Hamlets

Home local authority (above)

Please select up to 3 additional local authorities if required:

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Local authority:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Start date: 10/12/2024

End date: 10/12/2024

Number of times streamed/ broadcast:

Number: 1

Name of broadcaster or streaming service/host:

Name: Zoom

Is the stream or broadcast

Confirmed to happen

Location details

Name of activity: Project Evaluation Meeting With Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - ZOOM

Location options: Streaming or Broadcast

Will the event be streamed or broadcast locally, nationally or internationally?:

Please select all that apply: Local - the local authority where you're based (this can include up to three other local authorities)

Please click the 'Save' button below after you have answered the question.

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Local authority: Tower Hamlets

Home local authority (above)

Please select up to 3 additional local authorities if required:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Start date: 24/03/2025

End date: 24/03/2025

Number of times streamed/ broadcast:

Number: 1

Name of broadcaster or streaming service/host:

Name: Zoom

Is the stream or broadcast

Confirmed to happen

Location details

Name of activity: Wired PR - Campaign Review Meeting w. Tebs Maqubela & Wired PR - ZOOM

Location options: Streaming or Broadcast

Will the event be streamed or broadcast locally, nationally or internationally?:

Please select all that apply: Local - the local authority where you're based (this can include up to three other local authorities)

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Please click the 'Save' button below after you have answered the question.

Local authority: Tower Hamlets

Home local authority (above)

Please select up to 3 additional local authorities if required:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Start date: 10/04/2025

End date: 10/04/2025

Number of times streamed/ broadcast:

Number: 1

Name of broadcaster or streaming service/host:

Name: Zoom

Is the stream or broadcast

Confirmed to happen

Location details

Name of activity: PRS workshop for emergent participants (online)

Location options: Streaming or Broadcast

Will the event be streamed or broadcast locally, nationally or internationally?:

Please select all that apply: Local - the local authority where you're based (this can include up to three other local authorities)

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Please click the 'Save' button below after you have answered the question.

Local authority: Tower Hamlets

Home local authority (above)

Please select up to 3 additional local authorities if required:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Local authority:

Start date: 27/11/2024

End date: 27/11/2024

Number of times streamed/ broadcast:

Number: 1

Name of broadcaster or streaming service/host:

Name: Zoom

Is the stream or broadcast

Confirmed to happen

Location details

Name of activity: Livestream showcase @ Strongroom Studios

Location options: One physical place

Location details

Click to use postcode search:

or

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Click if within UK but no postcode is available:

☐

Click if international venue:

☐

Name of place: Strongroom

Street: Curtain Road

Town/city: LONDON

Postcode: EC2A 3SQ

Local authority: Hackney

Start date: 14/10/2024

End date: 14/10/2024

Number of times the activity is happening:

Number: 1

Contact name for the place:

Name: Jess Camilleri

Contact email address for the place:

Email: Jess@strongroom.com

Is the activity

Confirmed to happen here

Inclusivity and Relevance

What steps are you taking to make your project inclusive and relevant?

Up to 3000 characters

Inclusivity

- How will you make sure the communities you want to reach are able to access your project, and feel included and welcomed?
- What things might stop people experiencing or accessing your project, and how will you address them?

Relevance

- How have you involved the people you want to reach in the design and planning of your project?
- What information or data do you have on the place or community your project involves? How have you used this to shape your project?

THI combats systemic economic flaws within the music industry, & de-silos industry opps; increasing accessibility for emergent/Global Majority/lower-socio-economic creatives to become commercially viable, & advocating for fair pay for songwriters.

EMERGENT CREATIVES will receive astronomical exposure & upskilling via:

- a free to access programme, with paid work opps & bursaries to support with travel & project expenses
- direct exposure to industry leaders; increasing the quality of artist networks & seeding potential career opps extending beyond THI
- direct exposure to industry spaces, inc. the songwriting camp & livestream at elite venue Strongroom Studios; disrupting industry gatekeeping, & combatting socio-economic barriers to accessibility
- credits on a global, industry release with established industry artists/producers that would otherwise be inaccessible; authorising their professional capacity
- a PRS workshop in partnership with HART; showing emergent artists how to officially register songs (produced during the project) with PRS

MANAGEMENT INTERNS provided by SGS will gain vital music management experience; in association with respected industry figures. These devolved positions significantly increase their chances of starting & sustaining their professional careers.

SONGWRITERS' EQUITY

When a song is released via a major label, 'master point revenue (MPR)' (related to physical/digital sales) is strictly split between the record label, the artist on the song & the producer. Songwriters (responsible for the vocal melody & lyrics) receive no share of this revenue stream despite it being the most profitable part.

In summary: every party involved in the making of a track, inc the record label, profits from the work of the songwriters, EXCEPT for the songwriters themselves; an unfair & exploitative flaw in the music industry. THI embeds an equity model into its programme; giving songwriters an equal portion of the MPR; radically disrupting the industry standards & capturing THI's approach in a pedagogical document; available for industry figures to access.

Free pedagogical downloads will be made publicly accessible; distributed by project partners; designed to formally capture the inter-cultural grassroots/commercial bridging that THI facilitates, inc:

- fair-pay frameworks for songwriters in the industry
- accessibility guidance for grassroots creatives & project managers seeking to become commercially viable
- an inclusivity guide for industry figures; to diversify their thinking & expand their creative process
- THI impact reporting.

THI works with The Hidden Artists Network; an org that actively centres underserved & underrepresented artists inc. women, queer, non-binary, global majority, neurodiverse & disabled artists. They will attend stakeholder meetings & support the overall impact of future iterations; successfully pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology.

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Your planning

You've told us what you want to do and what you hope to achieve. We now need to understand how this will come together to be successfully delivered.

We need to know:

- Your project plan – what you're going to do and when
- Your plans for managing the project – you don't need to have managed a project before, but you need to show you've thought about what you'll do or who will support you
- Who you'll work with and how they'll contribute
- What your budget is and how you've worked it out, including paying everyone fairly
- How you will respond to challenges you might encounter

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Project timeline

Project Start Date: 16/09/2024

Project End Date: 30/09/2025

You've told us the start and end date of your project. We need to know what will happen during your project. Creating a timeline shows the key tasks that your project is made up of.

We understand that plans can change over the life of a project, but we need to see that you have a plan in place to deliver your project.

To create the table, click the 'Add new item' icon on the left of the screen to add a project stage. To add more than one stage, use the 'Save and Add another' button.

The table at the bottom of the page will populate with the information you enter about the stages of your project.

Start date	End date	Activity or task details	Task lead
16/09/2024		Communicate with all project partners via email to confirm availability for project start	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
23/09/2024		Formally book Strongroom Studio	Ben Hart
25/09/2024		Develop theory of change doc	Ben Hart
30/09/2024		Stakeholder Meeting 1: focus on the project plan & review/discuss project KPIs & roles	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
22/09/2024		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
30/09/2024	21/10/2024	Songwriting Camp: Ben Hart (HART) - 5 days songwriting within 1 month at Strongroom	Ben Hart
01/10/2024		Introduce Emerging and Established Creatives on Zoom. Provide Emerging Creatives with Feedback Forms	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
02/10/2024	03/10/2024	Strongroom Songwriting Camp: HART, JD Reid Production and Tej Writing Dates	Ben Hart & Jd Reid
04/10/2024	07/10/2024	Strongroom Songwriting Camp: HART, Max Pope Production and Lewis Ostwald Co-pr	Ben Hart & Max Pope
08/10/2024	09/10/2024	Strongroom Songwriting Camp: HART, Jabari Manwa Production and Sundjata Artist	Ben Hart & Jabari Manwa
10/10/2024	11/10/2024	Strongroom Songwriting Camp: HART, Mahalia and Ivo Todorov Artist & Producer C	Ben Hart & Mahalia
14/10/2024		Songwriting Camp: All Music Collaborators + Interns Meet at Strongroom for Adjustments	Ben Hart

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-000006782

17/10/2024		Stakeholder Meeting 2: reflect on writing camp & review project plans	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
14/10/2024		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
21/10/2024	22/10/2024	Xavier King Photo Shoot Date - 2 Days	Xavier King
25/10/2024	04/11/2024	Ben Stonely - Weekend Video Shoot Dates For 2 Singles Inc Edit Time - 10 Days	Ben Stonely
28/10/2024		Stakeholder Meeting 3: share project updates & next steps for the project	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
28/10/2024		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
11/11/2024		Finalise and Approve Demos w Emerging Creatives (Zoom) Before Sending to Damien For Mix &	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
11/11/2024		Collect Feedback Forms from Emerging Creative About How they Found their Sessions & Skill	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
11/11/2024		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
18/11/2024	25/11/2024	Damien Lewis - Mixing & Mastering Dates - 7 Working Days	Damien Lewis
25/11/2024		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
25/11/2024	06/12/2024	Revisions & Approve Masters - 5 Working Days + Register Songs PRS Workshop Wit	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
27/11/2024		PRS workshop for independent participants (online)	PRS & Ben Hart
09/12/2024		Stakeholder Meeting 4: share project updates & next steps for the project	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
09/12/2024		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
09/12/2024		Mixtape Roll Out Strategy Meeting W Tebs & SGS Interns	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
10/12/2024		Wired PR Strategy Meeting Including Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns	Rachel Campbell
10/12/2024	10/04/2025	Wired PR 4 month campaign for 2 singles & 1 mixtape	Rachel Campbell
11/12/2024		Tribal Digital Strategy Meeting Including SGS Interns	Tom Chaplin & Tebs Maqubela
12/12/2024	20/12/2024	Send singles to Tia O Donnell & Talk Creating a Sculpture For a 'Care Package'	Tia O Donnell
23/12/2024		Stakeholder Meeting 5: share project updates & next steps for the project	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
23/12/2024		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
27/12/2024	03/01/2025	Single 1 Roll Out - 2 Week Campaign	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
06/01/2025		Stakeholder Meeting 6: share project updates & next steps for the project	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
06/01/2025		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-000006782

10/01/2025	24/01/2025	Single 2 Rollout - 2 Week Campaign	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
20/01/2025		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
03/02/2025		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
07/02/2025	10/02/2025	Receive 10 x Sculptures / 'Care Packages' and SGS Interns Send Them For Industry	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
17/02/2025		Stakeholder Meeting 7: share project updates & planning for listening party	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
17/02/2025		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
21/02/2025	21/03/2025	Mixtape Rollout and Continue Sending 'Sculpture Care Packages' if needed - 4 W	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
21/02/2025		Listening Event @ Sixty Sixty Sounds	Jan Smosarski (owner)
03/03/2025		Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
24/03/2025		Project Evaluation Meeting With Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
10/04/2025		Wired PR - Campaign Review Meeting w. Tebs Maqubela & Wired PR	Rachel Campbell
16/04/2025		Stakeholder Meeting 8: share outcomes/stats from Wired PR meeting & discuss plans for future	Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela
23/04/2025	25/04/2025	Creation & web upload of pedagogical docs/ online resources	Ben Hart
28/04/2025		Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 1 with each of the 4 emerging creatives	Ben Hart
19/05/2025		Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 2 with each of the 4 emerging creatives	Ben Hart
23/06/2025		Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 3 with each of the 4 emerging creatives	Ben Hart
20/06/2025		Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 4 with each of the 4 emerging creatives	Ben Hart
18/06/2025		Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 5 with each of the 4 emerging creatives	Ben Hart
09/07/2025		Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 6 with each of the 4 emerging creatives	Ben Hart
15/09/2025	22/09/2025	Ben Hart Writes a 6 - Month 'Post-Project' Progress / Impact Report	Ben Hart
14/10/2024		Livestream showcase @ Strongroom Studios	Ben Hart

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Project plan details

Start date: 16/09/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Communicate with all project partners via email to confirm availability for project start

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 23/09/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Formally book Strongroom Studio

Task lead: Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 25/09/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Develop theory of change doc

Task lead: Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 30/09/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Stakeholder Meeting 1: focus on the project plan & review/discuss project KPIs & roles

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 22/09/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 30/09/2024

End date: 21/10/2024

Activity or task details: Songwriting Camp: Ben Hart (HART) - 5 days songwriting within 1 month at Strongroom

Task lead: Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 01/10/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Introduce Emerging and Established Creatives on Zoom. Provide Emerging Creatives with Feedback Forms

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Start date: 02/10/2024

End date: 03/10/2024

Activity or task details: Strongroom Songwriting Camp: HART, JD Reid Production and Tej Writing Dates

Task lead: Ben Hart & Jd Reid

Project plan details

Start date: 04/10/2024

End date: 07/10/2024

Activity or task details: Strongroom Songwriting Camp: HART, Max Pope Production and Lewis Ostwald Co-pr

Task lead: Ben Hart & Max Pope

Project plan details

Start date: 08/10/2024

End date: 09/10/2024

Activity or task details: Strongroom Songwriting Camp: HART, Jabari Manwa Production and Sundjata Artist

Task lead: Ben Hart & Jabari Manwa

Project plan details

Start date: 10/10/2024

End date: 11/10/2024

Activity or task details: Strongroom Songwriting Camp: HART, Mahalia and Ivo Todorov Artist & Producer C

Task lead: Ben Hart & Mahalia

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Project plan details

Start date: 14/10/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Songwriting Camp: All Music Collaborators + Interns Meet at Strongroom for Adjustments

Task lead: Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 17/10/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Stakeholder Meeting 2: reflect on writing camp & review project plans

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 14/10/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 21/10/2024

End date: 22/10/2024

Activity or task details: Xavier King Photo Shoot Date - 2 Days

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Task lead: Xavier King

Project plan details

Start date: 25/10/2024

End date: 04/11/2024

Activity or task details: Ben Stonely - Weekend Video Shoot Dates For 2 Singles Inc Edit Time - 10 Days

Task lead: Ben Stonely

Project plan details

Start date: 28/10/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Stakeholder Meeting 3: share project updates & next steps for the project

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 28/10/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Start date: 11/11/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Finalise and Approve Demos w Emerging Creatives (Zoom) Before Sending to Damien For Mix &

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 11/11/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Collect Feedback Forms from Emerging Creative About How they Found their Sessions & Skill

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 11/11/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 18/11/2024

End date: 25/11/2024

Activity or task details: Damien Lewis - Mixing & Mastering Dates - 7 Working Days

Task lead: Damien Lewis

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Project plan details

Start date: 25/11/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 25/11/2024

End date: 06/12/2024

Activity or task details: Revisions & Approve Masters - 5 Working Days + Register Songs PRS Workshop Wit

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 27/11/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: PRS workshop for independent participants (online)

Task lead: PRS & Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 09/12/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Stakeholder Meeting 4: share project updates & next steps for the project

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 09/12/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 09/12/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Mixtape Roll Out Strategy Meeting W Tebs & SGS Interns

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 10/12/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Wired PR Strategy Meeting Including Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns

Task lead: Rachel Campbell

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Project plan details

Start date: 10/12/2024

End date: 10/04/2025

Activity or task details: Wired PR 4 month campaign for 2 singles & 1 mixtape

Task lead: Rachel Campbell

Project plan details

Start date: 11/12/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Tribal Digital Strategy Meeting Including SGS Interns

Task lead: Tom Chaplin & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 12/12/2024

End date: 20/12/2024

Activity or task details: Send singles to Tia O Donnell & Talk Creating a Sculpture For a 'Care Package'

Task lead: Tia O Donnell

Project plan details

Start date: 23/12/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Stakeholder Meeting 5: share project updates & next steps for the project

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 23/12/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 27/12/2024

End date: 03/01/2025

Activity or task details: Single 1 Roll Out - 2 Week Campaign

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 06/01/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Stakeholder Meeting 6: share project updates & next steps for the project

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 06/01/2025

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 10/01/2025

End date: 24/01/2025

Activity or task details: Single 2 Rollout - 2 Week Campaign

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 20/01/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 03/02/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Start date: 07/02/2025

End date: 10/02/2025

Activity or task details: Receive 10 x Sculptures / 'Care Packages' and SGS Interns Send Them For Industry

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 17/02/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Stakeholder Meeting 7: share project updates & planning for listening party

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 17/02/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 21/02/2025

End date: 21/03/2025

Activity or task details: Mixtape Rollout and Continue Sending 'Sculpture Care Packages' if needed - 4 W

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 21/02/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Listening Event @ Sixty Sixty Sounds

Task lead: Jan Smosarski (owner)

Project plan details

Start date: 03/03/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns - Project & Budget Management Fortnightly Meetings

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 24/03/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Project Evaluation Meeting With Tebs Maqubela & SGS Interns

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 10/04/2025

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

End date:

Activity or task details: Wired PR - Campaign Review Meeting w. Tebs Maqubela & Wired PR

Task lead: Rachel Campbell

Project plan details

Start date: 16/04/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Stakeholder Meeting 8: share outcomes/stats from Wired PR meeting & discuss plans for future

Task lead: Ben Hart & Tebs Maqubela

Project plan details

Start date: 23/04/2025

End date: 25/04/2025

Activity or task details: Creation & web upload of pedagogical docs/online resources

Task lead: Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 28/04/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 1 with each of the 4 emerging creatives

Task lead: Ben Hart

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

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NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Project plan details

Start date: 19/05/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 2 with each of the 4 emerging creatives

Task lead: Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 23/06/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 3 with each of the 4 emerging creatives

Task lead: Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 20/06/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 4 with each of the 4 emerging creatives

Task lead: Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 18/06/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 5 with each of the 4 emerging creatives

Task lead: Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 09/07/2025

End date:

Activity or task details: Progress / Impact Check in Zoom 6 with each of the 4 emerging creatives

Task lead: Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 15/09/2025

End date: 22/09/2025

Activity or task details: Ben Hart Writes a 6 - Month 'Post-Project' Progress / Impact Report

Task lead: Ben Hart

Project plan details

Start date: 14/10/2024

End date:

Activity or task details: Livestream showcase @ Strongroom Studios

Task lead: Ben Hart

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

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Managing your project

What experience do you have of managing a project? I have managed projects like this before

Who will be working with you to deliver your project

For example this might be:

- A team of people (tell us who they are, and about their role and skills:...)
- A particular artist, practitioner or group (tell us: ...)
- A particular specialist(s) (tell us: ...)
- Other organisation(s) as collaborators, coproducers etc (tell us...)
- Other organisation(s) helping you to manage the project (tell us...)

How will they help you to deliver your project?

Up to 1500 characters

- What skills will they bring?
- If some people's involvement isn't confirmed yet, do you know what you'll do if they can't be involved?

THI leverages connections with highly competitive industry relationships that HART has established whilst writing for major label artists. HART has carefully curated pairs of 4 emerging artists & 4 established industry producers/artists to collab & skills share, inc:

ESTABLISHED/INDUSTRY

- Producer, JD Reid (mixed British): 2x platinum selling; critically acclaimed for his ability to produce across genres; his collabs inc: Skepta, Mabel, Katy B.
- Producer, Max Pope (white British): guitarist & artist too, he recently left record label Virgin EMI to increase ecological sustainability for independent musicians
- Producer, Jabari (Black Grenada/LA): alt hip-hop/R&B hit producer who was part of BROCKHAMPTON for a decade
- Artist, Mahalia (mixed British): Grammy nominated, & MOBO award winner

EARLY CAREER/EMERGING

- Producer, Lewis Ostwald (white British): guitarist who will gain exponential skills dev in the fusing of digital production & instrumentation
- Producer, Ivo Todorov (Bulgarian/British): a early-career artist, relatively new to production but showing huge potential
- Writer, Tejy (Black British): has written for Col3trane, & had cuts with Eric Bellinger, but struggled to leverage this momentum
- Artist, Sundjata Felix (Black British): has amassed 50k+ views on his YouTube, 200k+ streams on DSPs, & received coverage from Rinse FM & Complex.

To add a partner

To add a partner, click the 'Add new item' icon on the left of the screen. To add more than one partner, use the 'Save and Add another' button.

Name	Main contact	Email address	Role in project	Confirmed or expected
HART	Ben Hart	bshgb1@gmail.com	Project lead, songwriter, a...	Confirmed
Tebis Maqubela		tebs.maqubela@gmail.com	Project Management: Head of...	Confirmed
JD Reid	Jordan Reid	jdreidmusic@gmail.com	ESTABLISHED Producer: JD Re...	Confirmed
Jabari Manwa	Jabari Manwa	jabari@atoli.life	ESTABLISHED Producer: Jabar...	Confirmed
Max Pope		mpopemusic@gmail.com	ESTABLISHED Producer: Max P...	Confirmed
Mahalia		mahaliarose@gmail.com	ESTABLISHED Artist: Mahalia...	Confirmed
Ivo Todorov		ivo.todorov@gmail.com	EMERGING Producer: Ivo will...	Confirmed
Lewis Ostwald		lewis.ostwald@hotmail.co.uk	EMERGING Producer Lewis wil...	Confirmed

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Tejy		andretej@gmail.com	EMERGING Writer: Tej is an ...	Confirmed
Sundjata Felix		Sundajatamgmt@gmail.com	EMERGING Artist: Sundjata i...	Confirmed
Skitch	Ben Stonely	bstonely@gmail.com	Video Director Ben Stonely ...	Confirmed
Xavier King		xavieraking@gmail.com	Photographer: The press pho...	Confirmed
Tia O Donnell		tiod@gmail.com	Creative Director and Care ...	Confirmed
Damien Lewis		damienlewis@gmail.com	Mixing & Mastering Engineer...	Confirmed
Wired PR	Rachel Campbell (Founder)	rachel@wired-pr.co.uk	Music Publicist: Overseeing...	Confirmed
Tribal Digital	Tom Chaplin (Founder)	tom@tribal-digital.co.uk	Digital Marketing Executive...	Confirmed
PRS	Joe Frankland	Joe@prsfoundation.com	Promotional Partner - Signp...	Confirmed
Too Lost	Support Team	support@toolost.com	Distribution: Too Lost will...	Confirmed
Small Green Shoots	Natalie Wade (Founder)	natsx@smallgreenshoots.co.uk	Small Green Shoots (SGS) wi...	Confirmed
Sixty Sixty Sounds	Jan Smosarski	jan@sixtysixtysounds.com	Venue: Sixty Sixty will hos...	Confirmed
Hidden Artists Network	Saskia Coburn	saskia@sasolo.co.uk	Hidden Artists is an intera...	Confirmed
Submit Hub	Jason	jason@submithub.com	SubmitHub is the most trans...	Confirmed

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Partners details

Name: HART

Main contact (if organisation): Ben Hart

Email address: bshgb1@gmail.com

Role in project: Project lead, songwriter, artist & producer: Founder of The HART Initiative, he will play a dynamic role in the project, overseeing all elements of its execution, managing the teams, & creatively contributing as an artist, writer, organizer, producer, and mentor. HART has written for: Mahalia on upcoming EP, & 2nd album; securing 9 cuts inc ft from Stormzy, Destin Conrad & Joyce Wrice; Jabari Manwa, member of BROCKHAMPTON; RM, member of BTS; Sinead Harnett; Aitch & The England Lionesses.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Tebs Maqubela

Main contact (if organisation):

Email address: tebs.maqubela@gmail.com

Role in project: Project Management: Head of A&R at Mark Ronson's Zelig Records. He will oversee the management of the budget during this project. Tebs has overseen the rollout of many campaigns with large budgets exceeding £100,000 during his years at Columbia Records and his role as head of A&R at Hillman Grad of Defjam Records & Zelig. He is responsible for finding and nurturing musical talent whilst playing an integral role in artist development through music creation, marketing, and promotion.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Partners details

Name: JD Reid

Main contact (if organisation): Jordan Reid

Email address: jdreidmusic@gmail.com

Role in project: ESTABLISHED Producer: JD Reid is a London-based Double-Platinum selling producer who has been critically acclaimed for his ability to produce music across varying genres, inc Hip-Hop, Pop, and R&B. His collaborators include Mahalia, Slowthai, Skepta, Mabel, Katy B, Kojey Radical, and Dominic Fike, among others. He has performed at Boiler Room and, in November 2020, released his mixtape 'North West's Finest' exclusively on Bandcamp, which was a success and included Denzel, Biig Piig, and Zilo.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Jabari Manwa

Main contact (if organisation): Jabari Manwa

Email address: jabari@atoli.life

Role in project: ESTABLISHED Producer: Jabari Manwa is a well-established Alt Hip-Hop/RnB producer from St. George's, Grenada, who was part of BROCKHAMPTON for the past decade. He has produced some mainstream hits such as 'SUGAR' by BROCKHAMPTON and is expected to bring the finesse needed to allow this independent project to compete in the mainstream market.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Name: Max Pope

Main contact (if organisation):

Email address: mpopemusic@gmail.com

Role in project: ESTABLISHED Producer: Max Pope is an amazing guitarist with extensive experience in creating alt RnB and soul music. Max Pope will assist Ben Hart during the session with Lewis Ostwald, an up-and-coming producer. Max Pope, who has collaborated with artists such as Mahalia and ABRA, is also an artist in his own right, having recently left his record label Virgin EMI to pursue an independent career. In this way, he and Ben Hart share a similar mission to make independent careers more sustainable.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Mahalia

Main contact (if organisation):

Email address: mahaliarose@gmail.com

Role in project: ESTABLISHED Artist: Mahalia has achieved major success over the last few years, including Grammy nominations and MOBO awards. She will be supporting Ben Hart in the session with Ivo. Both Ben Hart and Ivo have much to learn from Mahalia, particularly regarding songwriting techniques from both lyrical and melodic perspectives.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Ivo Todorov

Main contact (if organisation):

Email address: Ivo.todorov@gmail.com

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Role in project: EMERGING Producer: Ivo will participate in a session with Mahalia, a well-established British RnB artist. He will also assist Ben Hart in making final tweaks to the mixtape during their regroup session, along with all of the other emerging creatives.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Lewis Ostwald

Main contact (if organisation):

Email address: lewis.ostwald@hotmail.co.uk

Role in project: EMERGING Producer Lewis will take part in the collaborative sessions with Max Pope. Both Lewis and Max also play guitar, so Lewis has much to learn from Max beyond production skills. Lewis, along with all the other emerging creatives, will also assist during the revisions regroup session.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Tejy

Main contact (if organisation):

Email address: andretej@gmail.com

Role in project: EMERGING Writer: Tej is an exciting new songwriter. He has been writing for Col3trane, one of the biggest RnB artists in the UK, and has had cuts with Eric Bellinger, one of the biggest RnB artists globally. However, he is struggling to grow off the back of this momentum. Tej will help write during his session with JD Reid, bringing his authentic RnB sound to the project.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Partners details

Name: Sundjata Felix

Main contact (if organisation):

Email address: Sundajatamgmt@gmail.com

Role in project: EMERGING Artist: Sundjata is a London-based musician who has been making waves in the underground scene, amassing tens of thousands of views on his YouTube channel and hundreds of thousands of streams on platforms such as Spotify. He has also received coverage from Rinse FM and Complex, among others. With this in mind, it is exciting that Sundjata will feature on one of the tracks on this project and take part in the Jabari Manwa session.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Skitch

Main contact (if organisation): Ben Stonely

Email address: bstonely@gmail.com

Role in project: Video Director Ben Stonely runs his own video production company, Skitch. He will be responsible for filming, editing, and color grading two videos for the lead singles of the mixtape. He will ensure the videos are of an industry standard.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Name: Xavier King

Main contact (if organisation):

Email address: xavieraking@gmail.com

Role in project: Photographer: The press photos for this project could potentially become cover art shots. Xavier has done a variety of shoots for fashion magazines, jewelry companies, and artists. This variety of work allows him to think outside the box when working within a specific sector, which will benefit this project. They also have a longstanding working relationship and have no problems butting heads when they disagree on something, resulting in the best final result.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Tia O Donnell

Main contact (if organisation):

Email address: tiod@gmail.com

Role in project: Creative Director and Care Package Creator for Industry Executives: Renowned for her clear and unique style that distinguishes her creations. For this project, she will be responsible for crafting sculptures to send out to industry executives upon the EP's release. Ben Hart believes that sending personalized packages to music industry influencers is an excellent way to forge connections with individuals who have the potential to significantly advance the project participants' careers.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Damien Lewis

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Main contact (if organisation):

Email address: damienlewis@gmail.com

Role in project: Mixing & Mastering Engineer: Grammy-nominated mixing engineer and producer. He has served as a Governor of the Recording Academy's San Francisco and Atlanta, & Chairman of The Producers & Engineers Wing San Francisco. Collabs inc: Justin Timberlake, Tame Impala, and Lizzo. He will be mixing and mastering of the songs for this project, leveraging his extensive experience to provide a professional edge that ensures the project stands out amidst the vast amount of music released daily.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Wired PR

Main contact (if organisation): Rachel Campbell (Founder)

Email address: rachel@wired-pr.co.uk

Role in project: Music Publicist: Overseeing the PR campaign and coordinating with relevant staff members to meet project expectations, Wired PR boasts a track record of catapulting independent artists into the mainstream. Their strategy includes radio, magazine, and playlist plugging through an extensive network, with a success rate surpassing competitors in the industry. Wired PR offers the best value, providing more effective results that justify the investment.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Tribal Digital

Main contact (if organisation): Tom Chaplin (Founder)

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Email address: tom@tribal-digital.co.uk

Role in project: Digital Marketing Executive: Tom will support with the project via his own company Tribal Digital. His expertise will give the project a competitive edge.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: PRS

Main contact (if organisation): Joe Frankland

Email address: Joe@prsfoundation.com

Role in project: Promotional Partner - Signposting: Ben oversees initiatives to promote new cohorts and enhance visibility. Once the proof of concept is established, the idea is for the PRS Foundation to feature this project on their application page, akin to open funds and other funding opportunities. There is potential for PRS Foundation to invest in or fund the project directly.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Too Lost

Main contact (if organisation): Support Team

Email address: support@toolost.com

Role in project: Distribution: Too Lost will distribute the music to major DSPs (e.g. Spotify & Apple Music)

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Name: Small Green Shoots

Main contact (if organisation): Natalie Wade (Founder)

Email address: natsx@smallgreenshoots.co.uk

Role in project: Small Green Shoots (SGS) will provide two management interns whom Tebs and Ben will mentor throughout this project. SGS specializes in cultivating relationships and offering support to the creative industries, particularly focusing on underrepresented young individuals. They create pathways for disadvantaged youth by providing access to the music and creative sectors through paid training programs and secondment opportunities with industry partners.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Sixty Sixty Sounds

Main contact (if organisation): Jan Smosarski

Email address: jan@sixtysixtysounds.com

Role in project: Venue: Sixty Sixty will host THI's culminating listening event. Located on Denmark Street in London, the venue is conveniently accessible and situated in a vibrant area. Given the presence of guitar shops nearby, noise is not a concern, adding to the venue's appeal.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Hidden Artists Network

Main contact (if organisation): Saskia Coburn

Email address: saskia@sasolo.co.uk

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Role in project: Hidden Artists is an interactive digital platform to educate, develop, visibilise & improve outcomes for artists & their projects. Centring underserved & underrepresented artists inc. women, queer, non-binary, global majority, neurodiverse & disabled artists. Connecting grassroots artists, organisations & gatekeepers, developing early-stage projects to become financially sustainable.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Partners details

Name: Submit Hub

Main contact (if organisation): Jason

Email address: jason@submithub.com

Role in project: SubmitHub is the most transparent way to send your songs to music blogs, Spotify playlists, TikTok and Instagram influencers, and more.

Confirmed or expected: Confirmed

Budget: How much are you applying to us for?

We need to know how much money you are applying to us for.

We'll ask you to tell us how much money you'll have to spend on the project (the income) and what you will spend it on (the expenditure). We'll also ask you to think about any challenges for your project and explain how you will respond to these.

Whilst we understand that budgets can change over the life of a project, this information allows us to see how you've planned your budget and how realistic it is that your project will deliver what you want it to.

Please read the Budget section of our Guidance for Applicants for help on completing your budget.

Please tell us the total amount you are applying to us for, including any personal access costs (£): £29,875

How much of this request is for your/your collaborators' personal access costs (£)? £0

What do we mean by 'Personal access costs'?

*If you, or any of the core team of people you are delivering the project with, experience barriers because you identify as:

- D/deaf or disabled
- neurodivergent
- experience learning difficulties
- having a mental health condition
- having a long term health condition

there may be extra costs relating to your access needs. These would be to:

- help you deliver the project; or
- for the online management of your grant.
- Some examples are: a BSL interpreter, a notetaker, or specialist tutor for admin support, or counselling costs.

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Costs can only be for the project period (between your project start date and end date).

Costs for caring responsibilities or costs for making your activity accessible to the people experiencing your project, including participants, can be included as part of your project budget but should not be included as personal access costs.

Only include personal access costs that you will have if your application is successful. This does not include costs relating to preparing, planning and submitting your application.

You can find more about personal access costs, and more about how we can support you to submit an application, in our Access Support information sheet.

If your personal access costs take your request over £100,000 we will still treat your application as an application for £30,001 and over

Lottery funding

Do you, or does your organisation object to receiving National Lottery funding for religious, cultural or ethical reasons? No

Fair pay

We are committed to making sure creative and cultural practitioners and those who work in the creative and cultural sector are paid fairly.

Please read the Fair pay section in our Project Grants guidance library for more information.

Have you used a recognised industry standard to work out how to pay creative and cultural practitioners and any other sector professionals involved in your project (including you)? Yes

What industry standard did you use?
Up to 600 characters

The HART Initiative uses rates given by the Artists Union/Musicians Union, previous iterations & industry standards to inform their pay for creative practitioners. Additionally, THI increases the standards for Fair Pay; advocating for songwriter equity by ensuring fair pay for songwriters who are typically marginalised within standard industry protocol as outlined in detail in the attached example doc.

How many people working with you to deliver your project will be employed on a freelance basis? 16

Statutory responsibilities

Tick the option that feels relevant: If there are people being paid or people volunteering as part of your project, you confirm you are aware of your responsibilities

The latest government guidance on employing people is here.

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Budget - Income

Income table

Please complete the income table below with all your cash income, as well as any support in kind you will receive.
By support in kind we mean goods or services that you would otherwise have to pay for, but are being provided for free.

Remember:

- Your budget must balance. This means your total income needs to be the same amount as your total expenditure.
- Only include income that relates specifically to this project.
- Do not include personal access costs in the income table. These are automatically included in the total amount you are requesting from us.
- For any earned income you should include how these amounts have been calculated in the description field, for example:
Ticket sales (7 dates @ 60% of 100 capacity x £8 ticket price) £3,360

To add an income line

To add each income line, click the 'Add new item' icon on the left of the screen. To add more than one line of expenditure, use the 'Save and Add another' button.

Income summary

Income heading	% Project value	Amount (£)
Earned income	1.13%	£825
Local authority funding	0.00%	£0
Other public funding	0.00%	£0
Private income	5.48%	£4,000
Income total (cash)	6.61%	£4,825
Support in kind	52.47%	£38,300
Arts Council England Funding	40.92%	£29,875
Income total	100.00%	£73,000

Expected / confirmed summary

Income heading	% Project income	Amount (£)
Expected	1.91%	£825
Confirmed	98.09%	£42,300
Income total	100.00%	£43,125

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Please tick the box if you have less than 10% funding from sources other than the Arts Council.

☐

Income heading	Description	Expected or confirmed	Expected confirmed date	Amount
Earned income	Streams & downloads	Expected	21/09/2025	£600
Support in kind	Reduced rate from Damien Lewis for Mixing & Mastering = 8 songs @ £...	Confirmed	---	£6,400
Support in kind	Tia Creative Director £500 Per Month Retainer - 5 Months = £2500	Confirmed	---	£2,500
Support in kind	Mahalia Reduced Collaboration Rate of £700 from £15000. Usual fee f...	Confirmed	---	£14,300
Support in kind	Jabari Manwa Reduced Collaboration Rate of £700 from £5000. This is...	Confirmed	---	£4,300
Support in kind	JD Reid Reduced Collaboration Rate of £700 From £5000. This is JD R...	Confirmed	---	£4,300
Support in kind	Max Pope Reduced Collaboration Rate of £700 from £1000. This is Max...	Confirmed	---	£300
Earned income	Sixty Sixty Sounds Showcase Event Ticket Sales (50 Capacity x 60% t...	Expected	24/02/2025	£225
Support in kind	Reduced rate on studio time	Confirmed	---	£5,600
Private income	Ben Hart reserves	Confirmed	---	£2,000
Private income	Tebs Maqubela	Confirmed	---	£1,000
Private income	Mahalia Private investment	Confirmed	---	£1,000
Support in kind	Sixty Sixty Venue Hire for listening event	Confirmed	---	£600

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Income details

Income heading: Earned income
Description: Streams & downloads
Expected or confirmed: Expected
When will this expected income be confirmed: 21/09/2025
Amount (£): £600

Income details

Income heading: Support in kind
Description: Reduced rate from Damien Lewis for Mixing & Mastering = 8 songs @ £200 Per Song reduced from £1000 per song x 8 Songs = £1600 so saving of £6400
Expected or confirmed: Confirmed
Amount (£): £6,400

Income details

Income heading: Support in kind
Description: Tia Creative Director £500 Per Month Retainer - 5 Months = £2500
Expected or confirmed: Confirmed
Amount (£): £2,500

Income details

Income heading: Support in kind

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Description: Mahalia Reduced Collaboration Rate of £700 from £15000. Usual fee for her to feature on a song in an industry setting = £10,000 alongside a £5000 writing fee. This is a flat fee and not normally measured on a day rate in practice.

Expected or confirmed: Confirmed

Amount (£): £14,300

Income details

Income heading: Support in kind

Description: Jabari Manwa Reduced Collaboration Rate of £700 from £5000. This is what Jabari Manwa would normally charge when working with an artist. This would normally be a flat fee rather than broken down into a day rate. This is industry standard.

Expected or confirmed: Confirmed

Amount (£): £4,300

Income details

Income heading: Support in kind

Description: JD Reid Reduced Collaboration Rate of £700 From £5000. This is JD Reid's normal flat fee for production when working with artists in industry.

Expected or confirmed: Confirmed

Amount (£): £4,300

Income details

Income heading: Support in kind

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Description: Max Pope Reduced Collaboration Rate of £700 from £1000. This is Max Pope's standard production fee when working with artists in industry. I want to highlight that in practice within the music industry nobody is paid to go to sessions. Instead, producers ONLY (that is, not songwriters) are paid after a song is selected to be released. This is another reason why this project is so important.

Expected or confirmed: Confirmed

Amount (£): £300

Income details

Income heading: Earned income

Description: Sixty Sixty Sounds Showcase Event Ticket Sales (50 Capacity x 60% turnout x £7.50 Tickets = £225)

Expected or confirmed: Expected

When will this expected income be confirmed: 24/02/2025

Amount (£): £225

Income details

Income heading: Support in kind

Description: Reduced rate on studio time

Expected or confirmed: Confirmed

Amount (£): £5,600

Income details

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Income heading: Private income

Description: Ben Hart reserves

Expected or confirmed: Confirmed

Amount (£): £2,000

Income details

Income heading: Private income

Description: Tebs Maqubela

Expected or confirmed: Confirmed

Amount (£): £1,000

Income details

Income heading: Private income

Description: Mahalia Private investment

Expected or confirmed: Confirmed

Amount (£): £1,000

Income details

Income heading: Support in kind

Description: Sixty Sixty Venue Hire for listening event

Expected or confirmed: Confirmed

Amount (£): £600

Income Questions

Tell us more about the match funding for your project
Up to 1500 characters

- How have you worked out the earned income you expect to receive during the project?
- How likely are you to secure your expected income?
- How will your project meet its aims if you receive less income than expected?

INCOME: the small amount of income will be supported by extra reserves

-Streams & Downloads:

Based on HART & Tebs (head of a&r @ Mark Ronson's 'Zelig' Records) insight + advertising conversion estimates: £4400 = 200,000 streams from major DSPs, & 150,000 streams from non monetised platforms eg. Youtube. Average income per stream of £0.003, 200,000 streams = £600 (200,000 x £0.003)

-Sixty Sixty Sounds Showcase Event Ticket Sales (50 Capacity x 60% turnout x £7.50 Tickets = £225)

-Ben Hart reserves £2000

Incredibly well established industry artists financially evidence their support for THI through private investments (Tebs & Mahalia) & reduced rates; leveraging their expert positions to support equity in the industry.

IN KIND:

-Reduced rate on studio time

-Sixty Sixty Venue Hire for listening event

-Damien Lewis for Mixing & Mastering £6400: £200 x 8 songs (instead of £1000)

-Tia Creative Director £2500: usual rate = £500 Per Month Retainer x 5 Months

-Mahalia £14300: £700 flat fee instead of usual rates: £10,000 for song ft + £5000 writing fee.

-Jabari Manwa £4300: £700 flat fee instead of usual rates: £5000 (industry standard)

-JD Reid £4300: £700 flat fee instead of usual rates: £5000 (industry standard)

-Max Pope £300: £700 instead of usual rates: £1000.

THI highlights that within industry practice, nobody is paid to go to sessions. Instead, producers ONLY (not songwriters) are paid after a song is selected to be released.

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Budget - Expenditure

Expenditure table

Please complete the expenditure table below with all your cash expenditure.

Remember:

- Your budget must balance. This means your total expenditure needs to be the same amount as your total income.
- Only include expenditure that will be spent between the start and end date of your project.
- The table already includes any Support in kind you added on the Income screen so you do not need to add this.
- Include example breakdown for expenditure, for example: Artist fee (£300 per day x 30 days) £9,000

Spending (expenditure) summary

Expenditure heading	% Project value	Amount (£)
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	27.95%	£20,400
Other artistic or creative costs for delivering the activity	7.81%	£5,700
Making your work accessible	0.00%	£0
Developing your organisation and people	2.60%	£1,900
Marketing and developing audiences	6.85%	£5,000
Overheads	0.00%	£0
Assets - buildings, equipment, instruments and vehicles	0.00%	£0
Environmental responsibility costs	0.00%	£0
Other	2.33%	£1,700
Personal access costs	0.00%	£0
Expenditure total (cash)	47.53%	£34,700
Support in kind	52.47%	£38,300
Expenditure total	100.00%	£73,000

Total income (for information): £73,000

To add an expenditure line

To add each expenditure line, click the 'Add new item' icon on the left of the screen. To add more than one line of expenditure, use the 'Save and Add another' button.

Expenditure	Description	Amount
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Project Management Fee for financial management and project oversig...	£2,500
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Admin Fees For Organising zooms, Check ins, all sessions and mentor...	£2,800

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Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Ben Hart (HART) - Songwriting & Preparing Ideas Alone @ Strongroom ...	£1,000
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Writing & Production - Ben Hart (HART) With Collaborator Sessions (...)	£1,600
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	JD Reid - Production (£350 x 2 Days)	£700
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Tej - Writing (£200 x 2 Days)	£400
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Max Pope - Production (£350 x 2 Days)	£700
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Lewis Ostwald - Production (£200 x 2 Days)	£400
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Jabari Manwa - Production (£350 x 2 Days)	£700
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Sundjata - Artist Collab & Writing (£200 x 2 Days)	£400
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Mahalia - Writing/ Artist Collab (£350 x 2 Days)	£700
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Ivo Todorov - Production (£200 x 2 Days)	£400
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Music Adjustments Regroup. 1 day at Strongroom. (£100 per person x ...)	£1,100
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Xavier King Photo Shoot (£200 x 2 day)	£400
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Ben Stonely - Videographer - 10 Days Work - (£1500 Per Video x 2 Vi...	£3,000
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Damien Lewis Mixing & Mastering 1/5 Normal Fee of £1000 Per Song. P...	£1,600
Marketing and developing audiences	Tia Sculpture Making Sculptures (£150 Per Day x 4 Days)	£600
Other artistic or creative costs for delivering the activity	Emerging artists' project bursaries (£200 x 4 people)	£800
Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs	Small Green Shoots Management Interns @ £1000 each for the duration...	£2,000
Marketing and developing audiences	Digital Advertising - Ad Spend Budget - 2 Singles x £250 + Mixtape ...	£1,500
Marketing and developing audiences	Wired PR 4 Month Campaign Start Date 2024 - End Date 2025 - 2 Singl...	£2,000
Marketing and developing audiences	Submit Hub - (2 Singles x £200) + (Mixtape £500)	£900
Other artistic or creative costs for delivering the activity	World Class Studio Time @ Strongroom Shoreditch (£350 p/d x 14 Days)	£4,900
Developing your organisation and people	Pedagogical document creation & web upload	£500
Developing your organisation and people	Project evaluation process (£200 x 7 days)	£1,400
Other	Contingency	£1,700

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Project Management Fee for financial management and project oversight (£250 x 10 days)

Amount (£): £2,500

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Admin Fees For Organising zooms, Check ins, all sessions and mentoring + any changes + Monitoring (£200 x 14 days)

Amount (£): £2,800

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Ben Hart (HART) - Songwriting & Preparing Ideas Alone @ Strongrrom (£200 x 5 Days)

Amount (£): £1,000

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Writing & Production - Ben Hart (HART) With Collaborator Sessions (£200 x 8 Days)

Amount (£): £1,600

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: JD Reid - Production (£350 x 2 Days)

Amount (£): £700

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Tej - Writing (£200 x 2 Days)

Amount (£): £400

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Max Pope - Production (£350 x 2 Days)

Amount (£): £700

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Lewis Ostwald - Production (£200 x 2 Days)

Amount (£): £400

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Description: Jabari Manwa - Production (£350 x 2 Days)

Amount (£): £700

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Sundjata - Artist Collab & Writing (£200 x 2 Days)

Amount (£): £400

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Mahalia - Writing/ Artist Collab (£350 x 2 Days)

Amount (£): £700

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Ivo Todorov - Production (£200 x 2 Days)

Amount (£): £400

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Music Adjustments Regroup. 1 day at Strongroom. (£100 per person x 9 people + 2x SGS interns = 11 total)

Amount (£): £1,100

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Xavier King Photo Shoot (£200 x 2 day)

Amount (£): £400

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Ben Stonely - Videographer - 10 Days Work - (£1500 Per Video x 2 Videos)

Amount (£): £3,000

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs

Description: Damien Lewis Mixing & Mastering 1/5 Normal Fee of £1000 Per Song. Project £200 Per Song x 8 Songs

Amount (£): £1,600

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Marketing and developing audiences

Description: Tia Sculpture Making Sculptures (£150 Per Day x 4 Days)

Amount (£): £600

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Other artistic or creative costs for delivering the activity
Description: Emerging artists' project bursaries (£200 x 4 people)
Amount (£): £800

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Paying people - artistic, creative, specialist costs
Description: Small Green Shoots Management Interns @ £1000 each for the duration of the project x 2 people
Amount (£): £2,000

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Marketing and developing audiences
Description: Digital Advertising - Ad Spend Budget - 2 Singles x £250 + Mixtape as a Whole @ £1000
Amount (£): £1,500

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Marketing and developing audiences
Description: Wired PR 4 Month Campaign Start Date 2024 - End Date 2025 - 2 Singles & Mixtape Release - £2000
Amount (£): £2,000

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Marketing and developing audiences

Description: Submit Hub - (2 Singles x £200) + (Mixtape £500)

Amount (£): £900

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Other artistic or creative costs for delivering the activity

Description: World Class Studio Time @ Strongroom Shoreditch (£350 p/d x 14 Days)

Amount (£): £4,900

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Developing your organisation and people

Description: Pedagogical document creation & web upload

Amount (£): £500

Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Developing your organisation and people

Description: Project evaluation process (£200 x 7 days)

Amount (£): £1,400

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Expenditure details

Expenditure heading: Other

Description: Contingency

Amount (£): £1,700

Expenditure questions

What experience do you have of managing a project budget of this size? I have managed a project budget of this size or larger before

How have you worked out the costs for paying people included in your budget?

Up to 1500 characters

THI leverages industry connections; with venues & artists offering 80%+ discounts on their usual rates; an active demonstration of their favour & appetite for this project, & THI's overall ethos.

- Project Management Fee for financial management and project oversight (£250 x 10 days)
- Admin Fees For Organising zooms, Check ins, all sessions and mentoring + any changes + Monitoring (£200 x 14 days)
- Ben Hart (HART) - Songwriting & Preparing Ideas Alone @ Strongroom (£200 x 5 Days)
- Writing & Production - Ben Hart (HART) With Collaborator Sessions (£200 x 8 Days)
- JD Reid - Production (£350 x 2 Days)
- Tej - Writing (£200 x 2 Days)
- Max Pope - Production (£350 x 2 Days)
- Lewis Ostwald - Production (£200 x 2 Days)
- Jabari Manwa - Production (£350 x 2 Days)
- Sundjata - Artist Collab & Writing (£200 x 2 Days)
- Mahalia - Writing/ Artist Collab (£350 x 2 Days)
- Ivo Todorov - Production (£200 x 2 Days)
- Music Adjustments Regroup. 1 day at Strongroom. (£100 per person x 9 people + 2x SGS interns = 11 total)
- Xavier King Photo Shoot (£200 x 2 day)
- Ben Stonely - Videographer - 10 Days Work (£1500 Per Video x 2 Videos)
- Damien Lewis Mixing & Mastering - £200 Per Song x 8 Songs
- Small Green Shoots Management Interns @ £1000 each for the duration of the project x 2 people £2,000

How have you worked out the other artistic or creative costs included in your budget?

Up to 1500 characters

THI understands that systemic inequality within the industry means that emerging artists are not as well paid globally, as the project's established artists. THI therefore extends Emerging artists' project bursaries (£200 x 4 people)

THI has secured a £5,600 discount on World Class Studio Time @ Strongroom Shoreditch. The project's rate = £350 p/d x 14 Days: £4,900

How have you worked out the costs of developing your organisation included in your budget?

Up to 1500 characters

Pedagogical documents will capture the learnings from THI's implementation & de-silo industry insights: cost of creation & web upload £500

Project evaluation process will capture the overall effect of THI & inform future iterations (£200 x 7 days)

How have you worked out the costs of marketing and developing audiences included in your budget?

Up to 1500 characters

-Tia will make sculptures to send to industry guests as part of the mixtape release strategycare packs (£150 Per Day x 4 Days)
-Digital Advertising - Ad Spend Budget: (2 Singles x £250) + (Mixtape £1000): £1,500
-Wired PR 4 Month Campaign 2024 - 2025: 2 Singles + Mixtape Release = £2000
-Submit Hub (the most transparent way to send your songs to music blogs, Spotify playlists, TikTok and Instagram influencers, and more): (2 Singles x £200) + (Mixtape £500)

How have you worked out the costs of expenditure listed as 'other' in your budget?

Up to 1500 characters

A contingency budget has been factored, to cover unforeseen circumstances/ lower than expected listening event ticket sales: £1,700

How much of your total project budget is being spent on International costs (such as visas, carnets, freight, travel, accommodation, per diems)? £0

Risks and challenges

There are risk and challenges to any project. Our funding can support you to take more risks than you might normally be able to. It may allow you to try new creative or cultural ideas, despite the unknowns and the possible financial or reputational risks.

Taking creative or cultural risk is important because it means that creativity and culture are always growing and changing.

It's important that you've thought about what the risks or challenges are. If they happen, you're then able to manage them and still deliver your project successfully.

If you want to understand more about risk, including the different types of risk, you can have a look at our Practitioners guide to identifying and managing risk information sheet.

What are the main risks and challenges to your project meeting its aims?

Up to 2000 characters

- What could go wrong?
- What might happen differently?

Risk 1 Tracks not finished in time with limited studio availability.

R2 Value exchange: established artists not valuing exchange opps; perceived to be 1 directional.

R3 Technological challenges: emerging participants may struggle with the advanced technology & equipment provided; hindering creative process.

R4 Adaptation to industry standards: participants might struggle to adapt their learning to real-world industry standards post program.

R5 Skills dev: skills gained might not be sustainable without continued support, practice, & accessibility to industry spaces, leading to a decline in participants' progress over time.

R6 Community pushback: resistance from the existing music industry community towards the disruptive nature of THI could create social friction.

R7 Networking & sustainability: emerging participants may fail to establish meaningful connections with industry leaders, &/or face difficulties achieving economic sustainability post-program; reducing the intended impact of the initiative.

What will you do to manage these risks?

Up to 2000 characters

- What plans have you put in place?
- Have these actions worked before?

Mitigation 1 Tracks not finished: THI will hold professional standards around the management of studio time, & creative expectations from participants, however in the event that tracks are not finished in time, HART will avail his home studio; suitable for finishing tracks, but not starting them from scratch.

R2 Value exchange: THI has clearly communicated the benefits for established artists: fresh perspectives, potential for innovation, & the opportunities to mentor & shape the next generation of talent. THI's mutual value for all creatives is an imperative factor in combatting elitish/gatekeeping industry norms; raising the value of underrepresented/emerging talent to impact the commercial industry's standards & style.

R3 Technological challenges: THI will offer ongoing technical support throughout the initiative; ensuring the highest possible skills dev throughout the programme. The teams will be aware of emerging artists' inexperience, and established artists understand their role as examples, guides & mentors.

R4 Adaptation to industry standards: THI offers an industry immersion for emerging artists; supporting them every step of the way. It is imperative that THI supports emerging artists with the business elements of navigating the industry, as well as the creative/technical aspects of making music so that their learning can be leveraged & sustained post programme.

R5 Skills dev: THI will maintain connections with the emerging artists' alumni; ensuring opportunities are continued & networking is maximised; additionally centering their voices in future iterations; tailoring THI's continuation based on their feedback.

R6 Community pushback: THI is already engaging industry connections, making them aware of the project's mission in a way that communicates value to them; invitations to engage with THI as stakeholders, & maintaining warm rapport in those connections that have been made through HART's role as a songwriter.

Safeguarding

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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You acknowledge that safeguarding is important in all projects working with the public. You acknowledge that if your project is funded you must sign up to Terms and Conditions that require you to have appropriate policies and procedures in place – and to put them into effect where needed – to support the safe delivery of the project.

X

About you / your organisation

We use all of this information in an anonymised way to help us see a clear picture of who we are supporting through Project Grants, and how this might need to change to ensure that, over time, the grants we make reflect the diversity of contemporary England.

We also use some of the information to help us make funding decisions.

Sometimes we prioritise supporting people and organisations who share characteristics that are underrepresented in recipients or beneficiaries of National Lottery Project Grants funding, so it helps us to know the characteristics of the individual or the organisation applying.

We believe that the creativity of each of us should be valued and given the chance to flourish, and every one of us should have access to a remarkable range of high-quality cultural experiences.

Equitable access to arts and culture funding is an important part of this. We believe the spread of who and what we invest in should reflect the makeup of the wider country we live in.

This is about us delivering on our Equality Objective:

We will ensure a more equitable distribution of our investment to improve opportunities for everyone, especially those with under-represented protected characteristics and from disadvantaged socio-economic groups.

We know from our data that Black, Asian and ethnically diverse people and disabled people are underrepresented as recipients and beneficiaries of National Lottery Project Grants funding. If you choose to tell us, information about your ethnicity and whether you identify as a disabled person may be used as part of our decision-making process. (If you're applying as an organisation, we'll use the information you give us about the characteristics of your organisation's board and/or senior management.) We will use this information combined with information about who your project will work with, and all the other information you give us about your project.

We will never share this information with others, except in an anonymised way.

If you're not comfortable sharing any of this information with us for this purpose, you can select 'Prefer not to say'.

Monitoring information

We use the information in this section to report how we have spent our funding from the National Lottery.

In this section, you must answer all the questions. If you prefer not to provide some of the information, you can tick the 'Prefer not to answer' box. We may use this information to report to the Government or to monitor the different backgrounds of people who receive grants.

Ethnicity:

White:	Select:
British	☐
Irish	☐
Gypsy, Roma or Irish Traveller	☐
Any other White background	☐

Mixed:	
White and Black Caribbean	☐
White and Black African	☐
White and Asian	☐
Any other Mixed/Multiple ethnic background	☒

Asian/Asian British:	
Indian	☐
Pakistani	☐
Bangladeshi	☐
Chinese	☐
Any other Asian background	☐

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Black/Black British:	
African	☐
Caribbean	☐
Any other Black background	☐

Other:	
Arab	☐
Latin American	☐
Any other ethnic background	☐
Prefer not to say	☐
Not known	☐

*** Please tick the description which best describes your sexual orientation:**

Sexual Orientation	Select:
Bisexual	☐
Gay Man	☐
Gay Woman/Lesbian	☐
Heterosexual/Straight	☒
Queer	☐
I identify in another way	☐
Prefer not to say	☐
Not known	☐

Applicant: Ben Hart

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What was the occupation of the highest income earner in your household when you were 14? senior manager/administrator

*** Which of the below do you feel best reflects this?**
Click here to see examples of how we define the occupations below

Socio-economic Background	Select:
Modern Professional Occupations	
Clerical and Intermediate Occupations	
Senior Managers and Administrators	
Technical and Craft Occupations	
Semi-Routine Manual and Service Occupations	
Routine Manual and Service Occupations	
Middle or Junior Managers	
Traditional Professional Occupations	
Self-employed	
Short Term Unemployed	
Long Term Unemployed	
Retired	
Not applicable	
Don't know	
Prefer not to say	
Other	x

Applicant: Ben Hart

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Age:

Age	Select:
0-19	
20-34	<input checked="" type="text" value="X"/>
35-49	
50-64	
65-74	
75+	
Prefer not to say	
Not known	

*** Disability status:**

Do you identify as D/deaf and/or Disabled person, or have a long term health condition?

	Select:
Yes	
No	<input checked="" type="text" value="X"/>
Prefer not to say	
Not known	

Neurodivergent:

Do you consider yourself to be neurodivergent?

	Select:
Yes	
No	<input checked="" type="text" value="X"/>

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

NLPG-00738866-V2-LON-UN-0000006782

Prefer not to say	☐
Not known	☐

Sex:

Sex	Select:
Female	☐
Male	☒
Intersex	☐
Prefer not to say	☐
Not known	☐

Gender Identity:

Gender Identity	Select:
Woman	☐
Man	☒
Non-binary	☐
I identify in another way	☐
Not applicable	☐
Prefer not to say	☐
Not known	☐

Sex registered at birth:

Is your gender identity different to your sex as registered at birth?

	Select:
Yes	☐
No	☒

Prefer not to say	☐
Not known	☐

Declaration

Data Protection and Freedom of Information

We are committed to being as open as possible. This includes being clear about how we assess and make decisions on Arts Council National Lottery Project Grants and how we will use your application form and other documents you give us. We are happy to provide you with copies of the information we hold about you.

We handle any personal data we receive in accordance with the United Kingdom General Data Protection Regulation, the UK Data Protection Act 2018 and other applicable laws that regulate the use and privacy of personal data (Data Protection Law). For more information about the personal data that we collect, what we use it for, and your data protection rights, please refer to our Privacy Notice.

As a public organisation we also have to follow the Freedom of Information Act 2000.

You must read the Freedom of Information (FOI) guidance on our website (<https://www.artscouncil.org.uk/our-organisation/freedom-information#t-in-page-nav-6>) before you sign your application.

By signing this application form, you acknowledge the following:

1. That we will use this application form and the information you give to us, including any personal data as referred to in our Privacy Notice, for the following purposes:
 - a) To decide whether to give you a grant.
 - b) To provide copies to other individuals or organisations who are helping us assess and monitor grants, including local authorities, other lottery distributors and organisations that award grants. After we reach a decision, we may also tell them the outcome of your application and, if appropriate, why we did not offer you a grant.
 - c) To hold in our database and use for statistical purposes.
 - d) If we offer you a grant, we will publish information about you relating to the activity we have funded, including the amount of the grant and the activity it was for. This information may appear in our press releases, in our print and online publications, and in the publications or websites of the Department for Digital, Culture, Media and Sport (DCMS) and any partner organisations who have funded the activity with us.
 - e) If we offer you a grant, you will support our work to campaign for arts and culture, contributing (when asked) to important publicity activities during the period we provide funding for. You will also give us, when asked, case studies, images and audio-visual materials that we can use to celebrate artistic and cultural excellence.
 - f) As an organisation that gives out public funds, we may carry out checks on the personal and financial information you provide us. If you provide false, fraudulent or inaccurate information in your application or at any point in the lifetime of any funding agreement we enter into with you, we may share the information about you with other National Lottery distribution bodies and relevant external bodies to prevent fraud and money laundering. If we identify or suspect fraudulent activity we will report this to the police and take appropriate action.

Applicant: Ben Hart

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I confirm that, as far as I know, the information in this application is true and correct.

X

I confirm that I am 18 years old or over (or will be at the time of accepting any grant offer made)

X

Name: Ben Hart

Date of birth: 18/07/1997

2. You have read and understood our Freedom of Information (FOI) guidance (<https://www.artscouncil.org.uk/freedom-information#section-6>) and acknowledge that if information about this application is requested under the FOI Act, we will process that request in line with our obligations under the FOI Act.

3. Tick this box to confirm you meet our bank account requirements as set out in our Bank Details guidance.

X

4. Tick the relevant box if any person involved in the project or writing the application:

I am happy to be contacted by Arts Council England, or by a third-party organisation on behalf of Arts Council England, for feedback to help evaluate the programme.

X

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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How did we do

Your feedback is important to us.

Every year we review National Lottery Project Grants to keep improving the programme. We'll look at these responses each time we do a review.

All answers are anonymous. They won't be seen by anyone deciding on your application.

To what extent do you agree with the following statements:

Arts Council provided the guidance needed to complete a Project Grants application

The guidance provided by Arts Council was easy to find

The questions in the application form were easy to understand

The questions in the application form helped with planning my project

What do you value about Project Grants?

Applicant: Ben Hart

51021975

Project: The HART Initiative: songwriting camp, mixtape release & networking opps; platforming emergent & industry musicians, & pioneering a vital culture shift within the UK's music ecology

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Submission summary

The submission summary displays a list of all the steps you've worked through. If you have completed a step successfully, there will be a green tick beside it. If a step is incomplete or has not been completed successfully, this will be indicated by a red tick. A hyperlinked statement will tell you what part of each step needs attention. Click on this hyperlinked statement to take you to the step and make your amendments.

By clicking submit, you are submitting your completed application form for our consideration.

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Getting Paid in the Music Industry

There are three main revenue streams through which musicians can be paid for releasing their music. These are 'Master Point' Revenue, 'Publishing' Revenue and 'Fees'. In short, 'Master Point' revenue relates to 'physical/digital sales' which typically occur through streaming and physical record sales, 'Publishing' Revenue relates to the intellectual property of a song – the vocal melody and lyrics – and 'Fees' relate to an upfront charge for your working on a particular song.

Master Point Revenue

In the music industry, when a song is released via a major label, master point revenue is strictly split between the record label which released the song, the artist on the song and the producer of the song. The songwriters (the people who are responsible for the vocal melody and lyrics) receive no share of this revenue stream despite this being the most profitable stream. This means that every party involved in the making of a given track, as well as the record label who were not involved in the track's creation, profits from the work of the songwriters *except* for the songwriters themselves. This highlights the unfair and exploitative nature of the Music industry.

In general, for every 1 million streams, £5000 of revenue is generated per streaming platform. 60% of this £5000 then goes to the Master point revenue stream for the record labels to pay out and the remaining 40% goes to the publishing revenue stream. This means that for every £5000, £4000 goes to the master point shareholders: record labels, artists and producers and £1000 goes to the publishing shareholders: artists producers and songwriters. It follows that master points are 5x more valuable than publishing percentages as 1 master point equates to £50 whereas 1% in publishing equates to £10 and songwriters, despite writing what could be an entire song are not entitled to any master points whatsoever. We can also see that the publishing revenue stream is not only smaller but split between more people so that the songwriters receive a smaller share of a smaller share of the money made from their work.

Artists who have a history of songwriting for others such as RAYE are currently making a stand against record labels and demanding master point royalties. However, up & coming songwriters with less 'clout', 'success' and therefore leverage will be told that their song will not be released if they ask for master points. The record labels do this because they know that songwriters need songs to be released in order to earn money from the *publishing* revenue (which I will go into in detail in a moment) and to make progress in their career, such as signing a publishing deal. In the end, therefore, songwriters are forced to accept this exploitation and receive 'something' instead of 'nothing' for their work.

Publishing Revenue

When a song is released publishing revenue is generated. It is then paid out to those people who were involved in creating the song. This usually includes the artist, the producer and the songwriter. In most cases this is split evenly between each party: 33.3% each. However, in some cases, when working with a huge global artist, they might demand a higher share

despite not having contributed as much. In this scenario, the producer and songwriter usually give up some of their percentage to satisfy the artist. As explained above, publishing revenue generates far less money than master point revenue and to make it worse, it is paid out quarterly. On top of that, it can take publishing collection agencies like the PRS up to 2 years to find and collect money for songwriters and producers. Given that songwriters have no other source of income from their music, this makes it almost impossible to sustain writing songs as a career given that one might spend two years writing an album for an artist without getting paid (as creators only get paid once a song is chosen to be released by a record label – never before) and then wait another two years to see any income from the songs on that album being streamed. It is true that major publishing companies are able to collect money faster due to their vast network and relationships globally. However, to get signed by a major publisher you need to have major cuts (cuts = releases) with other artists which requires a lot of work and finding the time to do this work is becoming increasingly difficult for songwriters given that they receive no day rate from labels, no master points and when they do land a release, it often takes 1 year + to see any income from it. It is an impossible and unsustainable way to live life.

In contrast, when a song is chosen for an advert, advertising agencies or brands usually pay a fee and this fee is split between the publishing shareholders. However, this is a rare occurrence and also requires a publisher to find or offer these opportunities to producers and songwriters.

Fees

Up front 'fees' are reserved for artists and producers only. For artists, they usually charge a fee for featuring on another artists' song. Similarly, producers charge an up-front fee for producing a particular record. In contrast, if a songwriter were to ask for a fee for writing a song after a record label has decided they want to use it for one of the artists on their roster, the record label would threaten not to release the song. The reason behind this is that 'paying songwriters is not in their [the record label's] 'business model'.

Conclusion

From the above, we can see that songwriters are being exploited as they receive a fraction of a fraction of the total revenue generated by their work. Despite the fact that songs wouldn't exist without them, they are not paid anything by record labels who make huge profits from their work and out of pure necessity to make ends meet, they are forced to accept terrible terms regarding the royalty rate on the sales of their own work. In this way, they are the voiceless beating heart of the music industry that need more representation. The HART Initiative aims to make steps towards this goal by paying songwriters fairly and strictly using songwriters who cannot currently sustain or develop a professional career in music due to the unfair and exploitative culture that record labels and the music industry thrives off.